PP-F-381J
April 17, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Int.Fed. Spec. PP-F-00381H(Army-GL)
March 31, 1971 and
Fed. Spec. PP-F-381G
January 15, 1965

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FISH: CHILLED AND FROZEN

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers fish, chilled and frozen, for use of all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following species, types, market forms, and grades as specified (see 6.1).

1.2.1 Species. The species shall be as specified.

1.2.2 Types.

I - Chilled (not previously frozen)
II - Frozen

1.2.3 Market forms. The fish shall be furnished in the following market forms:

Form I - Whole or round (not dressed)
Form II - Dressed
Form III - Fillets

(1) Single

(a) Skin on
(b) Skinless

(2) Butterfly

Form IV - Steaks
Form V - Chunks
Form VI - Portions

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1.2.4 Grades. Where applicable, the fish shall be of the following grades:

A
B

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-C-110	-	Cellophane (Coated and Noncoated Regenerated Cellulose Film)
L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
UU-P-31	-	Paper; General Specifications and Methods of Testing
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163	-	Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-101	-	Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Materials: Test Procedures
FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1483 - Sanitary Standards for Fish Plants

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. Department of Commerce

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Salmon Steaks
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Cod Fillets
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Haddock Fillets
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Halibut Steaks
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Ocean Perch and Pacific Ocean Perch Fillets
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Sole and Flounder Fillets
U.S. Standards for Grades of Whole and Dressed Fish

Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U.S. Department of Commerce, National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, National Marine Fisheries Service, Office of Inspection, Washington, DC 20240.)

U.S. Public Health Service

Drinking Water Standards of the U.S. Public Health Service

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The product shall be prepared from good quality fish, free from off-odors and foreign materials, which have been chilled by packing in adequate amounts of clean, crushed, or flaked ice, or by other means giving equivalent results, immediately after catching or removal from the water and continuously maintained in a thoroughly chilled condition until processing. Only current or latest season's pack is acceptable. Hatchery salmon (salmon after spawning), shall be removed and excluded.

3.2 Processing. Fish in excellent condition shall be processed into the market form specified (see 1.2.3). Until the start of processing, the fish shall be held ashore at an internal temperature of 40°F. or less. All water used for the washing of the fish and equipment shall comply with Drinking Water Standards of the U.S. Public Health Service.

3.2.1 Chilled fish. Type I fish shall be chilled to an internal temperature of 40°F. or less immediately following processing and shall be maintained at such temperature until delivery.

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3.2.2 Frozen fish. Fish shall be frozen by one of the following methods.

3.2.2.1 Conventional freezing process. The fish shall be frozen as follows:

(1) Freezing equipment. Blast freezer, or equivalent, shall be used to provide forced-air circulation while maintaining a freezer temperature of minus 10°F. (-23°C.) (or colder) during the freezing process.

(2) The fish shall be placed in the freezer within two hours from the time of processing.

(3) The temperature of the fish shall reach 0°F. (-18°C.) or lower within 72 hours after being placed in the deep freeze process.

3.2.2.2 Individual quick freezing process (IQF). The fish shall be frozen as follows:

(1) Freezing equipment. Cryogenic freezing equipment (gaseous nitrogen tunnel, rotating drum, plate freezer or other type of "quick freeze" equipment), shall be used.

(2) The fish shall be placed in the freezer within two hours from the time of processing.

(3) The temperature in the thickest part of the product shall be reduced to 0°F. or less within one hour after the product enters the freezer.

3.2.3 Glazing of frozen fish. After freezing, forms I, II, IV, when applicable, and form V shall be glazed with potable water and placed in storage of 0°F. (018°C.) or below.

3.3 Detailed processing requirements for types and forms.

3.3.1 Type I, chilled.

3.3.1.1 Form I, whole. Whole fish shall be uneviscerated and of good quality, good odor and free of foreign material.

3.3.1.2 Form II, dressed. The fish shall be of good quality, good odor, and free of foreign material, free of head, viscera, scales, fins, blood clots, and shall be washed. If specified, the head, fins or scales may be left on. For Department of Defense procurement the tail fin need not be removed unless specified (see 6.1).

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3.3.1.3 Form III, fillets. Fillets shall be of good quality, good odor, free of foreign material, and either skinless or with skin on as specified. Those fillets intended to be left with skin on must be cut from fish which were scaled and washed prior to filleting. The fillets shall be thoroughly washed in cold brine or cold potable water (when specified see 6.1), and thoroughly cleaned and drained before packaging. If the fillets are washed in brine (sodium chloride solution), the brine shall be no more than 15 degrees salometer and the washing time shall not exceed 2 minutes. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), fish fillets may be treated with food grade polyphosphates as permitted under the Food and Drug regulations governing the use of food additives, Section 121.101, subpart B. If polyphosphates are used the treatment shall consist of the application of a solution containing not more than 10 percent polyphosphates to fillets for a period not to exceed two minutes. The fillets shall weigh not less than three (85 g) nor more than 24 ounces (680 g) each, with the exception of the species listed in table I. Fillets without napes and fillets with edible boneless napes are acceptable. The nape is the hard cartilaginous portion of the fish lying immediately above the gill cover. The fillets shall be free from scales (fish to be processed into skinless fillets need not be scaled), natural extraneous material, bones, bruises, skin (skinless fillets), blood spots, black belly lining and pieces of fin (see 6.9). Abnormal fillets (jellied, milky or chalky) are not acceptable (see 6.9); see 3.8 for tolerances of parasites). Fillets packaged in a one-pound (454 g) package shall be permitted one piece under 3 ounces (85 g) to meet weight requirements. Scraps and fillets exhibiting poor workmanship (ragged or badly ruptured, smashed, stretched or missnapen) are not acceptable. Belly flaps shall be excluded from fillets (except butterfly fillets). Cross section cuts may be required on some fillets in order to meet weight requirements.

TABLE I. Species exempted from the 3 ounce minimum weights

Common name	Scientific name	Minimum fillet weight
Flounder		Ounces
(1) Yellowtail	Limanda ferruginea	2 (57 g)
(2) Blackback	Pseudopleuronectes americanus	2 (57 g)
(3) Dab	Hippoglossoides platessoides	2 (57 g)
(4) Dab	Scophthalmus aquosus	2 (57 g)
(5) Lemon sole	Pseudopleuronectes americanus	2 (57 g)
(6) English sole	Parophrys vetulus	2 (57 g)
(7) Gray sole	Glyptocephalus cynoglussus	2 (57 g)
(8) Dover sole	Microstomus pacificus	2 (57 g)
(9) Petrale sole	Eopsetta jordani	2 (57 g)
Ocean perch and Pacific Ocean perch	Sebastes marinus Sebastodes alutus	1 (28 g), unless otherwise specified (see 6.1)

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TABLE I. Species exempted from the 3 ounce minimum weights (cont'd)

Common name	Scientific name	Minimum fillet weight
		Ounces
Whiting (fillets)	Merluccius bilinearis	1-1/3 (38 g)
(butterfly fillets)		2-2/3 (75 g)
Yellow perch	Perca flavescens	1-1/3 (38 g)
White sea bass	Cynoscion nobilis	16 (454 g)
Yellowtail	Seriola dorsalis	16 (454 g)
Cabrilla	Epinephelus analogus	16 (454 g)
Grouper	Epinephelus species and Mycteroporca species	16 (454 g)
Jewfish	Promicrops itaiara	24 (680 g)

3.3.1.4 Form IV, steaks. Steaks shall be of good quality, good odor, and free of foreign material, cut approximately 5/8, 3/4, 7/8, and 1 inch (16, 19, 22, and 25 mm) thick, as specified (see 6.1), with a tolerance of plus or minus 1/8 inch allowed. Steaks shall weigh not less than 3 ounces (85 g), nor more than 24 ounces (680 g). Napes, including collarbones, and longitudinal tail cuts (caudal peduncle), are not acceptable. Steaks may be cut in half to meet weight requirements, but they shall be subdivided on the horizontal or vertical lines only; diagonal cuts are not acceptable. Steaks shall be free of workmanship defects such as loose skin, fins, blood spots, bruises, scales and pugh marks. Exceptions: Scales of halibut and salmon steaks need not be removed. Pectoral fins on halibut need not be removed if firmly attached.

3.3.1.5 Form V, chunks. Chunks are cross sections of large dressed fish cut at right angles to the backbone, which are of good quality, good odor and free of foreign materials. All fins and the nape with collarbone shall be excluded.

3.3.2 Type II, frozen. All forms shall be frozen according to 3.2.2, as applicable, and forms I, II, IV, and V shall comply with the glazing requirements of 3.2.3.

3.3.2.1 Forms I and II. Whole fish and dressed fish shall be completely glazed with potable water and shall be held at 0°F. (-18°C.), or below until delivery and shall comply with the requirements of 3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2, as applicable. When specified, each round fish shall bear a label placed on fish at time of initial freezing. The label shall bear the exact date of initial freeze and the species nomenclature (see 6.1). The proper glaze shall be maintained on the whole and dressed fish during storage.

3.3.2.2 Form III. Frozen fillets shall meet all applicable requirements of 3.3.1.3.

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3.3.2.3 Form IV. All species of frozen fish to be steaked shall comply with the requirements of 3.3.1.4 and must be identified by the supplier in such a manner that storage age of such fish can be ascertained to the satisfaction of the inspector. Steaks cut from frozen fish must be cut after the date of award of contract and individually glazed. Alternatively, the steaks may be cut from strictly fresh fish, then frozen and glazed. The saw and surrounding work area should be cleaned periodically to prevent the accumulation of sawdust on the steaks.

3.3.2.4 Form V. Chunks shall be completely glazed with cold potable water and shall comply with the requirements of 3.3.1.5.

3.3.2.5 Form VI. Portions shall be prepared from skin-on or skinless fish as specified, and shall be as follows:

Weights 2, 3, 4 ounces (57,85,113 g), or other weights and dimensions as specified (see 6.1). The portions shall be handled and processed in such a manner that they will result in a solid piece of fish flesh, and the pieces of fish comprising the portions shall not fall apart or disintegrate when cut, thawed, or cooked.

3.4 Description of grades. When so specified, the interpretation of requirements (descriptive terms), contained in 3.9.1, 3.9.2, 3.9.4, 3.9.5, 3.9.6, and 3.9.9 shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal (see 6.1).

3.5 Frozen storage. Once the fish product is frozen, glazed (where applicable), and properly packed, it shall be stored frozen as follows: (In no case shall the product temperature of the frozen fish exceed 0°F. (-18°C.) prior to frozen storage.

(1) The temperature in the approximate center of the packed boxes shall not exceed 0°F. (-18°C.) during the period of storage and at time of shipment.

(2) The temperature within the freezer shall be maintained at 0°F. (-18°C.) or below. The freezer temperature may fluctuate (not to exceed 6°F (-14°C.) for short periods to allow for entering the freezer to restock, withdraw, etc.

(3) The product shall be in excellent condition and the temperature in the approximate center of the packed boxes shall not exceed 0°F. (-18°C.) at time of acceptance by the Government.

(4) The product shall show no evidence of thawing or refreezing when examined at time of acceptance by the Government.

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3.5.1 Frozen storage time limits. The maximum storage limit for the frozen fish shall not be in excess of 180 days at the time of acceptance, calculated from the time the fish was initially frozen, with the following exceptions: Fillets of Pacific Ocean perch and bocaccio, 120 days, chillipepper, lobe-jawed rockfish, orange rockfish, red rockfish, and channel rockfish, 60 days; Atlantic Ocean Perch, 120 days. Storage time for halibut steaks shall be not in excess of 270 days, computed from time of initial freezing of the fish.

3.6 At time of delivery frozen or fresh fish shall be free of discoloration, foreign material and objectionable odors or flavors. Frozen fish shall be in excellent condition and shall show no evidence of objectionable dehydration or objectionable discoloration (see 6.9) for definitions or other deterioration characteristic of the species.

3.7 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.8 All fillets shall be thoroughly candled and free of parasites (see 4.2.4.6.2). (Exceptions: Parasites of class Trematoda genus Prosorphynchus or the Bucephalidae Family in Pacific Ocean Perch are acceptable in numbers exceeding the above requirement. However, they shall not exceed two parasites visible to the naked eye per fillet. Cod worm parasites, Porracaecum decipiens in the Cods, Family Gadidae are acceptable in numbers exceeding the above requirement. However, after thorough candling and removal, they shall not exceed two parasites, visible by candling, per fillet (see 4.2.4.6.2). Fillets too large to be effectively candled will, at vendors choice, either be excluded from the production lot or sliced to permit effective candling.

3.9 Detailed requirements. The following additional requirements for the individual species shall apply.

3.9.1 Halibut (Hippoglossus stenolepis and Hippoglossus hippoglossus).

(a) Grays, milkers, chalky and soft-textured fish are not acceptable.

(b) Dressed (chicken). Dressed weight shall be from 5 to 10 pounds (2.3 to 4.5 kg).

(c) Steaks. Steaks shall be cut from halibut of 10 pounds (4.5 kg) and over and shall weigh not less than 3 ounces (85 g) nor more than 24 ounces (680 g). Steaks from poke (body cavity), shall be not less than 1/2 inch (13 mm) thick at abdominal wall. Tail steaks shall be not less than 3 inches (76 mm) in largest diameter.

(d) Fillets, skinless. Fillets shall be prepared from chicken halibut (5 to 10 pounds ((2.3 to 4.5 kg)), or medium halibut (10 to 60 pounds ((4.5 to 27.2 kg)).

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3.9.2 Cod (Gadus morrhua and Gadus macrocephalus), sablefish (Anoplopoma fimbria), and lingcod (Ophiodon elongatus).

(a) Slightly greenish tinged flesh is not acceptable.

(b) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be 2-1/2 pounds to 10 pounds (1.1 to 4.5 kg).

(c) Steaks. Steaks shall weigh not more than 24 ounces (680 g).

(d) Fillets, skinless. Fillets shall be cut from fish weighing 2-1/2 (1.1 kg) pounds to 10 pounds (4.5 kg) or from small fish weighing 1-1/2 to 2-1/2 (0.7 to 1.1 kg) pounds as specified (see 6.1).

3.9.3 Rockfish fillets, skinless. The following species are acceptable, as specified (see 6.1):

Bocaccio (Sebastodes paucispinis)
Chillipepper (S. goodie)
Orange rockfish (S. pinninger)
Red rockfish (S. ruberrimus)
Channel rockfish (S. alascanus)
Lobe-jawed rockfish (S. diploproa)

3.9.4 Salmon. Species shall be red king (Oncorhynchus tshawytscha) or silver (Oncorhynchus kisutch) as specified (see 6.1):

(a) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be 6 pounds (2.7 kg) or over.

(b) Steaks. Steaks shall be cut from salmon of dressed weight of 6 pounds (2.7 kg). or over. Steaks shall weigh not more than 24 ounces (680 g). When specified, steaks from poke (body cavity), untrimmed, shall be not less than 1/2 inch (13 mm) thick at abdominal wall (see 6.1).

(c) Watermarking. Watermarked salmon are not acceptable.

3.9.5 Sole and flounder fillets. Skin shall be removed from both sides, except petrale and English sole, which may have skin remaining on blind (ventral) side.

(a) Jellied, milky or chalky fillets are not acceptable.

(b) The following species of sole and flounders are acceptable: Yellowtail (Limanda ferruginea), blackback (Pseudopleuronectes americanus - under 3-1/2 lbs.) (1.6 kg), dab (Hippoglossoides platessoides), dab (Scophthalmus aquosus), English sole (Parophrys vetulus), lemon sole

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(Pseudopleuronectes americus - over 3-1/2 lbs.) (1.6 kg), Gray sole (Glyptocephalus cynoglossus), petrale sole (Eopsetta jordanie), Dover sole (Microstomus pacificus), and starry flounder (Platichtyhs stellatus).

3.9.6 Haddock (Melanogrammus aeglefinus) fillets. Fillets shall be cut from large fish weighing 2-1/2 pounds (1.1 kg) and over or from small fish weighing 1-1/2 to 2-1/2 pounds (0.7 to 1.1 kg) as specified (see 6.1).

3.9.7 Pollock (Pollachius virens) fillets, skinless. Fillets shall be cut from fish weighing 2-1/2 pounds (1.1 kg) and over.

3.9.8 Mackerel: Atlantic (Scomber scombrus); Pacific (Scomber japonicus); and Spanish (Scomberomorus maculatus) fillets. Fillets shall be cut from fish weighing 1 pound (0.45 kg) and over. Fillets shall be washed in cold potable water, not brined.

3.9.9 Ocean perch (Sebastes marinus) and Pacific Ocean perch (Sebastodes alutus) fillets. Fillets, unless otherwise stated in the contract or order, may be skin-on or skinless and shall be cut from fish weighing 1/2 pound (227 g) and over. The maximum count shall be 120 fillets per 10 pounds (4.5 kg) with a tolerance per 10-pound carton of 10 fillets weighing less than 1 ounce (28 g). At certain times of the year, when specified (see 6.1), the maximum count may be extended to 150 fillets per 10 pounds (4.5 kg) with a tolerance per 10-pound (4.5 kg) carton of 15 fillets weighing less than 1 ounce (28 g).

3.9.10 Whiting (Merluccius bilinearis).

(a) Fillets. Fillets shall be cut from fish weighing 3/4 pound (340 g) or over.

(b) Butterfly fillets. Butterfly fillets shall be cut to exclude the vent.

3.9.11 White Sea bass (Cynoscion nobilis).

(a) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be from 6 to 50 pounds (2.7 to 22.7 kg).

(b) Steaks. Steaks shall weigh not more than 24 ounces (680 g).

3.9.12 Yellowtail (Seriola dorsalis).

(a) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be from 4 to 15 pounds (1.8 to 6.8 kg).

(b) Steaks. Steaks shall weigh not more than 24 ounces (680 g).

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3.9.13 Cabrilla (Epinephelus analogus).

(a) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be from 5 to 20 pounds (2.3 to 9.1 kg).

3.9.14 Jewfish (Pomicrops itaiara).

(a) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be from 10 to 100 pounds (4.5 to 45.4 kg).

3.9.15 Grouper (Epinephelus species and Mycteroporca species).

(a) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be from 10 to 100 pounds (4.5 to 45.5 kg).

3.9.16 Barracuda (Syphyraena argentea).

(a) Dressed. Dressed weight shall be 2-1/2 pounds (1.1 kg) or over.

(b) Steaks. Steaks shall weigh not more than 24 ounces (680 g).

(c) Fillets, boneless. Fillets shall be cut from barracuda weighing 4 pounds (1.8 kg) and over.

3.9.17 Swordfish (Xiphias gladius).

(a) Steaks. Steaks shall weigh not more than 24 ounces (680 g). Steaks from poke (body cavity) shall be not less than 1/2-inch (13 mm) thick at abdominal wall. Tail steaks shall be not less than 3 inches (76 mm) in largest diameter.

(b) Fillets, boneless. Fillets shall be cut from pieces weighing from 10 to 50 pounds (4.5 to 22.7 kg).

3.9.18 Smelt. The following species are acceptable as specified: Smelt (Osmerus mordax), Surfsmelt (Hypomesus pretiosus) and Eulachon (Thaleichthys pacificus).

3.9.19 Red snapper (Lutjanus blackfordii).

(a) Steaks. Steaks shall weigh not more than 24 ounces (680 g).

(b) Fillets. Fillets shall be cut from fish weighing 3/4 pounds (340 g) or over.

3.10 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, handled, and delivered under the sanitary conditions set forth in applicable paragraphs

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contained in Part 260 of The National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products. For Military procurement, when the above regulations are not enforced, the product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-1483.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling. Samples of the finished product covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished product may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirement.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 General. Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing and packaging, at any suitable point in transit, and after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 Factory inspection. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the supplier of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 Final inspection. Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.3 and 6.4).

4.2.4 Responsibility for inspection. The following statement is applicable for all species of fresh and salt water, whole or dressed fish. The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. When so specified in the contract or order (see 6.1), the supplier is required to furnish an official inspection certificate issued by the U.S. Department of Commerce certifying that the grade of the product supplied is as required by the contract or order.

The following statement is applicable for all species of fish in this specification except the products listed above: The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to perform the examination and tests prescribed herein, using his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government.

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4.2.4.1 Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2.4.2 Plant qualification conditions. The product furnished under this document shall be unacceptable, if not produced and stored in plants which currently meet the conditions of 3.10.

4.2.4.3 Acceptance inspection. Sampling for inspection and determination of acceptability shall be in accordance with provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, or sampling plans in U.S. Department of Commerce Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products. Where specified, compliance with the applicable U.S. Department of Commerce Grade Standards, and issuance of a certificate of Quality and Condition shall be deemed to fulfill all the requirements of this specification except those relating to storage limits and container requirements.

4.2.4.4 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.2.4 and 4.2.4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.4.4.1 Examination of fish prior to processing. Examination of fish prior to processing shall be made to determine compliance with the condition requirements of 3.1. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the component lot of fish.

4.2.4.4.2 Testing of components. Testing of components described in this specification shall be as shown below. Results shall apply to the lot average.

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TABLE II. Testing of components (see 4.2.4.4)

Component	Sample unit	Means of expressing lot size	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported	Test reference & rqmts. para.
Polyethylene	One bag or 12" x 12" (305x305 mm) panel	Number of bags or containers	S-2	Thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.0025 mm)	5.1.1.2 5.1.1.3.1.1 or 5.2.1.1c
Copolymer of vinylidene chloride and vinyl chloride	One bag	Number of bags	S-2	Thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.0025 mm)	5.1.1.2 5.1.1.3.1.1
Waxed paper, kraft or vegetable parchment (as applicable	Three square yards of ($2.5\ m^2$) cut sheets	Number of reams	S-2	Basis weight	Nearest pound per square inch	5.1.1.3.1.1 5.1.1.3.3, or 5.2.1.1a
			S-2	Weight of wax per ream	Nearest pound	5.1.1.3.1.1
			S-2	Melting point of wax	Nearest 1°F. (-17°C.)	5.1.1.3.1.1
				Bursting strength	Nearest pound	5.1.1.3.1.1
				Tearing resistance	Nearest gram	5.1.1.3.1.1
Cellophane	One half yard ($0.4\ m^2$) full width	Rolls	S-2	Gauge	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.0025 mm)	5.1.1.3.1.1 L-C-110

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TABLE II. Testing of components (see 4.2.4.4) (cont'd)

Component	Sample unit	Means of expressing lot size	Inspection level	Character-istics	Results reported	Test reference & rqmts. para.
Rubber hydrochloride	One bag or sheet	Number of bags or sheets	S-2	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.025 mm)	5.1.1.3.1.1 5.1.1.2(d)
Pasting chipboard	Two 12 inch by 12 inch (305x305 mm) panels	Number of liners	S-2	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.025 mm)	5.1.1.3.2
Heat shrinkable polyethylene bag	One bag or 12" x 12" (305x305 mm) panel	Bags or panels	S-2	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.025 mm)	5.1.1.2
Polyethylene terephthalate	One bag or 12" x 12" (305x305 mm) panel	Bags or panels	S-2	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.025 mm)	5.1.1.2 5.1.1.3.1.1

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4.2.4.5 Process examination. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), examination shall be performed during processing to determine compliance with the applicable requirements as specified in 3.2 through 3.3.2.5. Failure to comply shall be the basis for rejection of the lot.

4.2.4.6 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables III through V and 4.2.4.6.3 through 4.2.4.6.6. The inspection levels, sample units, expression of lot sizes, and the acceptable quality levels (AQLs) for the above tables shall be as shown below. AQLs shall be expressed in defects per hundred units.

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs Major A	Major B	Minor	Total
III	S-4	Bag, wrapper, carton or box	Shipping containers	-	2.5	4.0	
IV	S-4	As applicable:	Pounds/kg				
		Form I - fish		-	2.5	-	-
		Form II - fish		-	2.5	-	6.5
		Form III - 1 fillet		-	-	-	10.0
		Form IV - 1 steak		-	2.5	-	10.0
		Form V - 1 chunk		-	2.5	-	6.5
		Form VI - 1 individual portion		-	2.5	-	6.5
V	S-1	10 lbs. (4.5 kg) of product	Pounds/kg			4.0	

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TABLE III. Examination of packaging

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
		Form I, II or V
151		Product not wrapped
152		Wrapping material not as specified
	201	Product not individually or completely covered by wrapper
		Form III
	202	Product not individually or completely wrapped (when applicable)
153		Wrapping material not as specified
	203	Carton not waxed or fiberboard box not lined when product is individually wrapped (see 5.1.1.3.2)
154		Carton or fiberboard box not completely lined as specified when product is not individually wrapped (see 5.1.1.3.2)
		Form IV
	204	Product not individually or completely wrapped (when applicable)
155		Wrapping material not as specified
156		Carton not waxed or fiberboard box not lined (as applicable)
157		Carton or fiberboard box not completely lined as specified when product is not wrapped
	205	Product not arranged in layers or the thickness of a layer exceeds 1 steak (when applicable)
158		Wrapper or bag not closed as specified
159		Top layer not covered or cover not made of proper material (when applicable)
	206	Presence of water marking (applicable to salmon)
		Form VI
	207	Packaged weight not as specified
160		Bag material not as specified
161		Not completely inclosed in a prefabricated bag
	208	Layers not separated by wax paper insert or cartons not waxed (when applicable)

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TABLE III. Examination of packaging (cont'd)

Category		Defect
ajor B	Minor	
		Form VI (cont'd)
162		Bag does not form a tight, close fit conforming to the surface of the product
163		Method of closing bag not as specified
		Net weight of filled package 1/
	209	(Package 1 pound ((.45 kg)) or less) net weight more than five percent under specified weight
	210	(Package more than 1 pound ((.45 kg)) but not more than 10 pounds ((4.5 kg)) net weight more than two percent under specified weight
	211	(Package more than 10 pounds ((4.5 kg)) net weight more than one percent under specified weight

1/ To determine amount of glaze, when applicable, see 4.2.4.6.3.1

TABLE IV. Examination for product characteristics 1/ 2/ 3/ 4/

Category		Defect
ajor B	Minor	
		Forms I and II
151		Product not glazed or improperly glazed
152		Label missing showing exact date of initial freeze and species nomenclature when specified
		Form II
153		Presence of scales, head, viscera, fins, or blood clots (if specified, head fins, or scales may be left on form II)
		Form III
	201	Not free of bone (tally only once for each defect per fillet examined)
	202	Presence of fin or fin portion (tally only once per fillet)

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TABLE IV. Examination for product characteristics 1/ 2/ 3/ 4/ (cont'd)

Category Major B	Minor	Defect
		Form III (cont'd)
	203	Presence of skin (when skinless is specified)
	204	Presence of scraps or fillets exhibiting poor workmanship (ragged or badly ruptured, stretched or misshapen)
	205	Product weighs less than specified minimum (see table I) or exceeds 24 ounces (0.7 kg) (not applicable to ocean perch)
	206	Presence of belly flaps (applicable to single fillets)
154		Presence of blood spots, bruise, viscera, scales, black belly lining, or blemishes
		Form IV
	207	Product varies more than ± 1/8 inch (3 mm) from specified thickness
	208	Product weighs less than 3 ounces (85 g) or more than 24 ounces (0.7 kg). In addition halibut and swordfish tail steaks less than 3 inches (76 mm) in longest dimension or halibut and swordfish steak less than 1/2 inch (13 mm) at abdominal wall or salmon steak less than 1/2 inch (13 mm) at abdominal wall when so specified
	209	Presence of non-edible boneless nape
	210	Presence of longitudinal tail cut
	211	Product subdivided on other than horizontal or vertical lines
155		Presence of workmanship defects such as loose skin, fins, blood spots, scales, bruises, and pugh marks
156		Presence of collarbone
157		Product not glazed (when specified)
		Form V
	212	Product not cut at right angles to backbone
	213	Presence of fin or fin portion
	214	Presence of non-edible boneless nape or collarbone
158		Product not glazed

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TABLE IV. Examination for product characteristics 1/ 2/ 3/ 4/ (cont'd)

Category Major B	Minor	Defect
		Form VI
	215	Individual portion more than 1/4 inch (6 mm) smaller or larger than specified dimensions (see 6.1)
	216	Individual portion deviating more than ± 10 percent from specified weights
159		Portion falls apart or disintegrates when cut, thawed, or cooked

1/ Sample unit, as applicable, shall be cooked for examination of defect 156.

2/ Product shows an abnormal condition, evidence of objectionable dehydration, objectionable discoloration or other deterioration characteristic of the species shall be basis for rejection of the lot.

3/ Presence of foreign material (e.g., dirt, wood or metal particles, rust, paint, glass, hair or any other foreign material or off odor) shall be the basis for rejection of the lot.

4/ Linear measurements shall be measured to the next highest increment of measurements, and percent measured to the nearest whole percent and weights, weighed to the nearest 1/8 ounce (3.5 g).

TABLE V. Examination of count and weight of fillets

Category	Defect
Minor	Applicable to ocean perch only
201	More than 120 fillets or more than 130 fillets per 10 pounds (4.5 kg), as applicable
202	More than 10 fillets or 15 fillets (as applicable) less than 1 ounce (28 g) per 10 lbs (4.5 kg)

4.2.4.6.1 Examination of fillets prior to freezing. Classification of defects for fillets prior to freezing shall be in accordance with table VI.

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Lot size shall be expressed in estimated number of fillets. The sample unit shall be one fillet. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-4. The AQL's expressed as percent defective shall be 2.5.

TABLE VI. Examination of fillets prior to freezing

Category	Defect
Major B	
151	Fillet containing more than two prosorhynchus trematoda bucephalidae visible to the naked eye (applicable to Pacific Ocean perch only)
152	Fillet containing more than two porracaecum decipiens visible by candling (applicable to fish comprising the cods, Family Gadidae

4.2.4.6.2 Examination for parasites (other than specified in table VI) prior to freezing. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with requirements of 3.8. The sample shall be 100 fillets or pieces of fillets. The sample shall be derived from not less than [illegible] containers. Finding of any sample containing more than two parasites shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.4.6.3 Examination for net weight. The sample unit shall be one filled shipping container. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of the sample unit. Sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-4. The lot shall be rejected if, by using recognized statistical methods, the sample average net weight is determined to be less than the sample average marked net weight.

4.2.4.6.3.1 The procedure for determining the amount of glaze per shipping container, when applicable, shall be as follows:

1. Equipment needed

a. Source of cold tap water with aerated faucet.
b. Balance (scale) accurate to 0.1 gram, or 0.01 ounce for forms weighing less than one pound (454 g) and scales accurate to 1/16 ounce (1.6 g) for forms weighing one pound (454 g) or more.
c. Paper towels.
d. Small knife.

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2. Determination of average lot percent glaze

a. Weigh the glazed portions (4 portions shall be selected from a sample unit).

b. Remove glaze.

(1) Adjust tap water to a flow rate of approximately 3 quarts (2.8.1) per minute through aerated faucet.

(2) Direct 50° to 60°F. (10°C. to 16°C.) tap water onto fish while gently feeling and rubbing surfaces with fingertips (if necessary, temperature up to 80°F. (27°C.) (tap water) may be used, but requires closer control).

(3) When all glaze is removed from cut flesh surface, as evidenced by absence of slick feel to fingers, remove fish from water.

(4) Rapidly remove excess water with single application of paper towel before it has time to refreeze on the fish. If the skin is present, flick off residual skin glaze by knife or hand.

(5) Repeat steps (2), (3), and (4) on each portion selected from the sample unit.

c. Weigh de-glazed fish (see actual net weight).

d. Calculate percent glaze per sample unit.

$$\frac{\text{Total a} - \text{Total c} \times 100}{\text{Total a}} = \text{percent glaze per sample unit}$$

e. Calculation of average percent glaze for lot.

$$\frac{\text{Total percent glaze for sample units}}{\text{number sample units}} = \text{average percent glaze for lot.}$$

3. Calculation of net weight of fish in sample unit

a. Weight of sample unit (filled shipping container) - tare weight of shipping container (including wrapping materials, liners, etc.) = net weight of glazed fish in sample unit.

b. Net weight of glazed fish x average percent glaze = weight of glaze in sample unit.

c. Net weight of glazed fish - weight of glaze = net weight of fish in sample unit.

4.2.4.6.4 Examination for bones in cooked fish fillets. Unit samples of unfrozen fish fillet material demonstrating the presence of bones shall be examined as follows:

a. Mark the bone location in the fillet.

b. Place the unfrozen fish fillet material in a boilable film-type pouch.

c. Fold the pouch over a suspension bar and clamp it in place so that a loose seal is maintained.

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d. Immerse the pouch and its contents in boiling water and cook until the internal temperature of the fillets reaches 160°F. (71°C.) (about 20 minutes).

e. Remove the fillets from the boilable pouch. Examine the bones previously marked and determine whether or not they have softened sufficiently to be incapable of piercing or hurting the palate.

4.2.4.6.5 Examination of shipping container. Examination of the filled and closed shipping container for level B pack shall be in accordance with the examination criteria contained in the appendix to PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the table of examination. Major: Marking, missing, incorrect or illegible. Minor: (1) net weight more than 50 pounds (22.7 kg) as indicated by marked net weight; (2) not lined or not lined as specified. For level C pack, examination shall be in accordance with PPP-B-636 except that only the defects for marking and net weight shall apply.

4.2.4.6.6 Examination for frozen storage limits. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with 3.5 and 3.5.1. Failure to comply shall be basis for rejection of the lot.

4.3 Tests. Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the supplier will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test method specified herein will govern.

4.3.1 Chemical analyses. Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the methods of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal (see 6.1).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level B (frozen product only).

5.1.1.1 Forms I, II, and V. The frozen and glazed product shall be individually and completely wrapped in one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.3.1.1.

5.1.1.2 Form VI. Portions shall be packaged in approximately one (0.45 kg), five (2.3 kg) or 10-pound (4.5 kg) units, as specified (see 6.1). The product

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shall be completely enclosed in a prefabricated bag. Where more than one portion is enclosed in the bag, the layers shall be separated by a wax paper insert. The bags shall be processed by vacuum, pressure, or heat, or a combination of these, so that the bag forms a tight, close fit conforming to the surface of the product. The bag shall be string tied, heat-sealed, secured with pressure-sensitive tape, or closed with suitable metal clips. The bag shall be made of one of the following materials:

(a) Polyethylene, 0.0015-inch (0.0004 mm) thick or heat shrinkable polyethylene 0.001-inch (0.0003 mm) thick. Polyethylene shall be tested in accordance with L-P-378.

(b) A film formed by copolymerizing vinylidene chloride and vinyl chloride. The film shall be not less than 0.0015-inch (0.0004 mm) thick.

(c) A polyethylene terephthalate film not less than 0.0005-inch (0.0001 mm) thick.

(d) A special frozen-food-rubber-hydrochloride-base plastic film not less than 0.001 inch (0.0003 mm) thick.

5.1.1.2.1 Alternatively, the product may be packaged in a wax carton commonly used for the purpose. The wax carton shall be completely lined with one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.2.

5.1.1.3 Forms III and IV. The fillets or steaks shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.3.1, 5.1.1.3.2, or 5.1.1.3.3, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1.3.1 Wrapping. Fillets packaged in 1-, 2-1/2-, 5-, or 10-pound (0.45, 1.1, 2.3 or 4.5 kg) units should be completely wrapped, using one of the wrapping materials specified in 5.1.1.3.1.1. Glazing is not acceptable. Wrapping is not required for steaks to be bulk packaged.

5.1.1.3.1.1 Wrappers. The wrappers shall be of sufficient size to cover the product completely. The wrapper may be prefabricated into a bag, and the wrapper or bag shall be heat-sealed, string tied, secured with pressure-sensitive tape, or closed with suitable metal clips. The wrappers shall be of one of the following materials:

(a) Waxed paper. The wrapping material shall be bleached, semi-bleached, or unbleached deodorized kraft or sulphite paper or vegetable parchment having a minimum basis weight of 26 pounds (11.8 kg) per ream (24 by 36-500) before waxing. The paper or vegetable parchment shall be wet-waxed on both sides with not less than 9 pounds (4.1 kg) per ream (24 by 36-500) of a fully refined paraffin wax having an average melting point of not less than 125°F. (52°C.) when tested in accordance with Method 4017 of FED-STD-101. The waxed sheet shall have an average bursting strength of not less than 22 points, when tested in accordance with method 112 of UU-P-31, and an average tearing resistance in any direction of not less than 18 grams when tested in accordance with method 170 of UU-P-31.

(b) Cellophane conforming to type V, class 2, and having an area yield of 14,000 square inches (91,000 cm^2) per pound (kg) in accordance with L-C-110.

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(c) A rubber hydrochloride-base plastic film not less than .001-inch (0.03 mm) thick.

(d) Polyethylene 0.0015-inch (0.04 mm) thick having an area yield of not more than 21,500 square inches (139,750 cm^2) per pound.

(e) A film formed by copolymerizing vinylidene chloride and vinyl chloride. The film shall not be less than .001-inch (0.03 mm) thick.

(f) A polyethylene terephthalate film not less than 0.0005-inch (0.0001 mm) thick.

5.1.1.3.2 Cartons. Not less than one (0.45 kg) nor more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of the product, wrapped as specified in 5.1.1.3.1, shall be packaged in waxed cartons commonly used for the purpose. Alternatively, if the carton is completely lined with one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.3.1.1, the product need not be wrapped.

5.1.1.3.3 Bulk (applicable to form IV). The unwrapped product shall be packed directly into shipping containers as specified in 5.2.1.1. The boxes shall be waxed paper lined in accordance with 5.2.1.1.1. The steaks shall be arranged in layers; each layer shall be one steak in thickness. Each layer shall be separated by a sheet of waxed paper, as specified in 5.1.1.3.1.1 or unwaxed parchment having a minimum basis weight of 26 pounds (11.8 kg) per ream (24 by 36-500) which is cut the full length and width of the container. The top layer shall be covered by a sheet of waxed paper in addition to the waxed liner at the top of the shipping container. If the product being bulk packed is individually wrapped, the boxes may be waxed lined in accordance with 5.2.1.1.1 or 5.2.1.1.2 and the layers need not be separated by wax paper.

5.1.2 Level C. Unless otherwise specified commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 Packing. Not more than 50 pounds (22.7 kg) of fish shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level B. Fish shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1.1 or 5.2.1.2, as applicable.

5.2.1.1 All forms, packages other than cartons. The shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, V3c, V3s, V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, SWCFI, grade 275 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with

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the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Unless the product is packaged and sealed to prevent leakage, the interior surfaces of the style FTC box shall be protected by one of the following methods:

a. Completely lined inside with two sheets of waxed paper specified in 5.1.1.3.1.1, so placed as to separate the fish from the top, bottom, sides and ends of the shipping container. Each sheet shall be cut at least 2 inches (51 mm) wider than the surfaces to be protected and shall overlap at least 4 inches (102 mm) along the center at the top. One sheet shall be positioned over the top, sides, and bottom, and the other sheet shall be positioned over the top, ends, and bottom.

b. Hot waxed overall in the inside with a fully refined paraffin wax having an average melting point of 125°F. (52°C.) when tested in accordance with Method 4017 of FED-STD-101. The quantity of wax applied to the fiberboard shall be sufficient to show the presence of wax on the fingernail when it has been scraped lightly over the fiberboard.

c. Hot coated with polyethylene having a minimum thickness of 0.0005-inch (0.0001 mm).

5.2 [illegible] When specified (see 6.[illegible]), the shipping container specified in 5.2.1.1 shall be reinforced with nominal 1/2-inch (13 mm) wide pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.1.2 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.6), the shipping container shall be constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, SWCFI, grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. When necessary, the interior of the shipping container shall be protected as specified in 5.2.1.1.

5.2.1.2 Forms III, IV and VI in cartons. The shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V3c V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting, wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 275 of PPP-B-1163.

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5.2.1.2.1 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.5), the shipping container specified in 5.2.1.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2.2 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.6), the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, W5c, or W5s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting, wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level C. The shipping container shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Unit containers. Any commercial labeling or additional labeling as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder will be acceptable under this specification.

5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Unit containers. Commercial labeling will be acceptable.

5.3.2.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. For steaks, the date of initial freezing of the whole fish shall be marked on top of each container in number 1-1/2 (38 mm) to 2 inches (51 mm) in height. In addition, the following precautionary markings shall appear on the top of the container containing frozen fish in letters between 1 (25 mm) and 1-1/2 (38 mm) inches high, all letters being of the same height:

KEEP FROZEN
(0°F. OR BELOW)

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Species (common and scientific name), type, form, grade, (where applicable) and size of fish (see 1.2, 3.4, 3.9.2, 3.9.3, 3.9.4, and 3.9.6).
(c) When tail fin is to be removed (see 3.3.1.2).
(d) When washing of fillets in cold potable water in lieu of brine wash is desired (see 3.3.1.3).
(e) When treatment of fish with food grade polyphosphates is not desired (see 3.3.1.3).
(f) Weight of ocean perch fillet, if other than one ounce (28 g) (see table I).
(g) Weights required for form VI, if other than 2, 3 or 4 ounces (56.7, 85 or 113.4 g), and dimensions required (see 3.3.2.5 and table V).
(h) Appropriate thickness of steaks desired (see 3.3.1.4).
(i) For forms I and II. If round fish must bear a label (see 3.3.2.1).
(j) When inspection certificate issued by the U.S. Department of Commerce certifying grade of product is required (see 4.2.4).
(k) Thickness of salmon steaks when other than 1/2 (13 mm) inch (see 3.9.4).
(l) When chemical analyses are required (see 4.3.1).
(m) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(n) Quantity of portions (1, 5 or 10 pound or .45, 2.27 or 4.5 kg units) required (see 5.1.1.2).
(o) Style and kind of packaging required (see 5.1.1.3).
(p) Number of fillets specified (120 or 130 fillets) as applicable (see 3.9.9).
(q) When packing specified in 5.2.1.1.1, 5.2.1.1.2, 5.2.1.2.1 or 5.2.1.2.2 is required.

6.2 If samples with bids are necessary they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, or request for proposal, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid samples should be definitely stated.

6.3 Supplier's inspection. The supplier shall be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

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6.4 Destination inspection (for Civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.5 Packing specified 5.2.1.1.1 and 5.2.1.2.1 is intended for transfer at sea operations and special Navy overseas operations.

6.6 Packing specified in 5.2.1.1.2 and 5.2.1.2.2 should be used when experience or knowledge of the destination and mode of shipment would indicate that a lower grade of fiberboard can be used.

6.7 Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-5/MCO 4030.14D/ DSAR 4145.7, as applicable.

6.8 Award of contract for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 4.10 (also see 4. [illegible]).

6.9 For the purposes of this specification the following shall be considered instances of defects:

Skin	Presence of skin on skinless fillets or sample unit greater than 1/2 square inch (32 mm^2) in any dimension.
Scales	Presence of scales greater than an aggregate area of 1/2 square inch (32 mm^2) on any one sample unit.
Blood-Spot	Presence of blood-spots greater than an aggregate area of 1/2 square inch (32 mm^2) on any one sample unit.
Fin	Presence of fin material greater than an aggregate area of 1/2 square inch (32 mm^2) on any one sample unit.
Natural extraneous material	Natural extraneous material greater than an aggregate area of 1/2 square inch (32 mm^2) on any one sample unit.
Bruise	An aggregate area greater than 1/2 square inch (32 mm^2) on any one sample unit. A bruise larger than 1-1/2 square inches (96.8 mm^2) shall be considered as two.

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Black belly lining	Presence of black belly lining longer than 1/2 inch (32 mm^2).
Bones	An objectionable bone or group of bones are those capable of piercing or hurting the palate after cooking (see 4.2.4.6.4).
Objectionable dehydration	Moderate or excessive dehydration (deep enough to scrape off easily with fingernail).
Objectionable discoloration	Moderate or excessive yellowing or any rusting.
Abnormal condition	Jellied, milky or chalky.
Misshapen	Product distorted to a point where item is not recognizable as whole or round (not dressed) dressed or fillets, as applicable.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-0745

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

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(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

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	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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